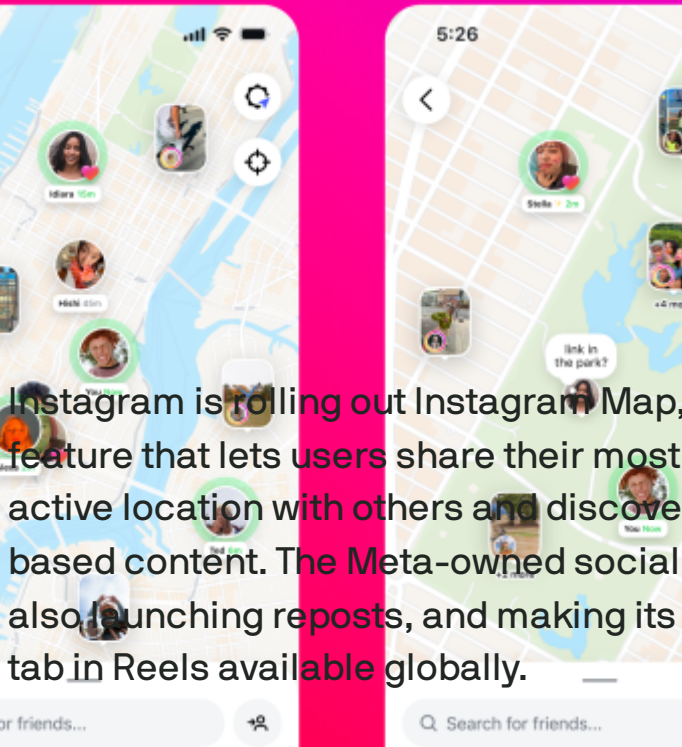


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Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'



Instagram is rolling out Instagram Map, a new feature that lets users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content. The Meta-owned social network is also launching reposts, and making its “Friends” tab in Reels available globally.

With its new map feature, Instagram is copying yet another popular feature from Snapchat, after cloning the app’s core Stories functionality [back in 2016](#). Instagram is coming for Snap Map’s crown, a feature that recently surpassed 400 million monthly active users and remains one of the app’s core offerings.

IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram notes that location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map, and a user’s location only updates when they open the app, meaning it doesn’t provide real-time location updates. Snap Map, on the other hand, allows users to choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

It’s worth noting that Instagram does offer [real-time location sharing via DMs](#) (direct messages). However, unlike Apple’s Find My and Snap Map, which let you share your location with others indefinitely, Instagram only lets users do so for up to one hour.

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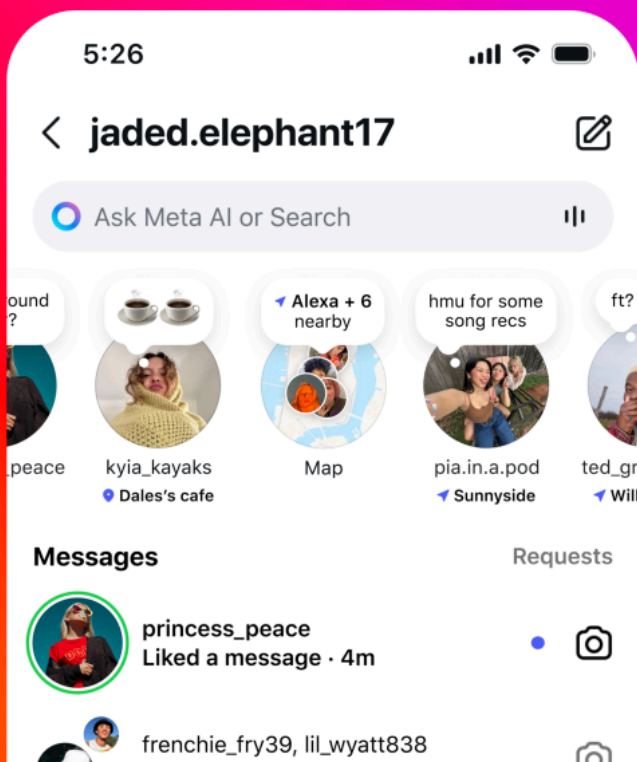


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram says the new map feature will make it easier for friends to coordinate and link up for hangouts. It also lets users explore location-based content that their friends and favorite creators have shared or engaged with. For example, if your friend attends a nearby music festival and posts a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

Regardless of whether you choose to share your location, you can use the map to explore location-based content, Instagram says.

The map also allows users to leave short messages, or "[Notes,](#)" on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are currently the short messages that appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, users can now post these short updates on the map.

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Although Instagram is certainly taking on Snapchat with this new feature, it also has the opportunity to appeal to people who were fans of [Zenly](#), a social map app that Snap acquired and then shut down in 2023.

The new map feature is launching in the United States starting Wednesday, with broader global availability coming soon. Users can find the Instagram Map at the top of their DM inbox.

The launch doesn't come as a surprise, as [Instagram was spotted developing](#) the map feature last year.



As for the new “Reposts” feature, Instagram is taking a page out of [TikTok’s book](#) while also creating its own version of the popular “retweet” function from Twitter (now X).

This feature lets Instagram users repost public reels and feed posts. These reposts may show up in their friends’ feeds and will also be displayed in a new “Reposts” tab on their profile. Instagram says the new feature gives users a way to share their interests with others and also offers creators the opportunity to reach a wider audience.

To repost a reel or post, users tap the repost icon. Users can also choose to add a note to the repost by typing into the thought bubble that appears on screen and pressing save.

Regarding the new “Friends” tab in Reels, Instagram launched it in the United States earlier this year and is now making it available globally. The tab lets you see public reels that your friends have liked, commented on, reposted, and created.

For users who want to browse and interact with content privately, Instagram is rolling out the ability to opt out of having content you’ve engaged with shown in the friends tab.

Users can hide their likes, comments, and reposts from the tab. Additionally, they can choose to mute likes, comments, and reposts from specific people they follow.

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Instagram will begin testing a new repost feature with select users soon

Aisha Malik — 1:25 PM PDT · September 8, 2022

Instagram is gearing up to give users the ability to repost other users' posts and reels, the social network confirmed to TechCrunch. Although the Meta-owned company hasn't released the repost

feature publicly yet, it plans to begin testing it with select users soon.

“We’re exploring the ability to reshare posts in Feed — similar to how you can reshare in Stories — so people can share what resonates with them, and so original creators are credited for their work,” a spokesperson from Meta told TechCrunch in an email. “We plan to test this soon with a small number of people.”

The new feature was first spotted by [social media consultant Matt Navarra](#), who posted a screenshot that showcases a Reposts tab. The tab will likely be home to all the posts and reels that users have reshared on their accounts. According to the screenshot, the Repost tab will appear on users’ profiles alongside the posts, reels and tagged photos tabs.

Instagram Reposts Tab on profiles?!

What’s dis Adam? pic.twitter.com/WayWCJGBfx

— Matt Navarra (@MattNavarra) [September 7, 2022](#)

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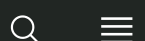
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reshare posts sometimes use third-party apps to do so. The addition of a repost feature would get rid of the need for workarounds when it comes to resharing posts. It's worth noting that although you can currently share someone's post in your Story, this upcoming repost functionality will let you share the post in your feed. Instagram is likely aware that many of its users already use the Stories share feature and also use DMs to share posts with friends, and is now trying to give users a better way to widely share posts they like.

The concept of reposts on social media arguably originated from Twitter's Retweet feature, which has since been adopted by other platforms. Instagram's plans for a repost feature come as [TikTok has been testing](#) its own version of Twitter's retweet with the addition of a new "Repost" button that allows users to amplify videos on the platform by sharing them with their own followers. But unlike a Twitter retweet, reposted videos on TikTok don't show up on your own TikTok profile, as they're only sent out to your friends' For You feeds.

In Instagram's case, reposts will appear in your followers' feeds and will also be displayed on your profile in the designated repost tab, according to the screenshot shared by Navarra.

It seems that Instagram has been working on reposts for at least a few months now, as app researcher Alessandro Paluzzi [spotted the feature](#) in development back in May. According to screenshots shared by Paluzzi, users will be able to find the repost option in the share menu. The screenshots also suggest that users will have the

option to add their own thoughts when resharing a post.

[#Instagram](#) keeps working on reposts 🙄

 Reposts will be saved in a separated tab on your profile pic.twitter.com/7bduidntwE

— Alessandro Paluzzi (@alex193a) [May 21, 2022](#)

If TikTok chooses to roll out the repost option more broadly, it could prove to be a new way for creators to get their content discovered. Also, as Instagram notes, it could be a way to ensure that original creators are credited for their work. Instagram is currently filled with reposted memes and photos that often don't credit original posters, so the addition of a repost feature could help ensure that original posters receive credit when their work is shared widely.

As with any other test feature, it's unknown when or if Instagram plans to release its repost functionality to all users. We'll likely learn more about the feature once it enters the testing phase shortly.

Although the introduction of a repost feature on Instagram may be a welcome addition for some users, others may see it as another feature that is bound to overcrowd the social network. Some users have already expressed frustration over Instagram's recent video-focused and [TikTok-like changes](#) that have steered it away from being a place to share photos with friends and family. The criticism recently forced Instagram to [walk back its full-screen feed test](#) and temporarily reduce the number of suggested posts that users see.

Instagram users haven't exactly been asking for more features, with many [actually calling for the platform](#) to go back to its roots. The addition of a repost feature may turn off some users from

Instagram even more, especially when it's a feature copied from other social networks.

TikTok tests its own version of the retweet with a new 'Repost' button



TikTok is testing its own version of Twitter's retweet with the addition of a new "Repost" button that allows users to amplify videos on the platform by sharing them with their own followers. The new Repost button is found in the "Share" menu where you could otherwise send the video to friends through messages, texts ... [Continue reading](#)

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Instagram tests a reposts feature

Aisha Malik — 12:04 PM PDT · June 16, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: [SILAS STEIN/PICTURE ALLIANCE](#)

/ GETTY IMAGES

Instagram is testing the ability for users to repost posts, the company confirmed to TechCrunch on Monday. The move doesn't come as a surprise, as the social network was [spotted developing](#) the feature as far back as 2022.

Some users have [reported seeing](#) the feature on their accounts, with one [noting that users](#) will be able to repost their own content in addition to other users' posts.

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Of course, not everyone will be on board if Instagram decides to roll out the change officially, especially since it would add yet another content format to a platform already overcrowded with posts, Stories, Reels, Notes, DMs, ads, and more.

On the other hand, some people will welcome the change since it will allow them to share and amplify interesting content like they already do on other platforms.

Although you can currently share someone's post in your Story, this upcoming repost functionality will let you reshare the post in Instagram's Feed. In addition, some people currently use workarounds and third-party apps to repost content, so an official reshare feature would get rid of the need to find alternatives.

As for creators, the repost functionality could be a way for them to boost their reach and discoverability. Plus, Instagram is flooded with reposted memes and photos that often don't credit original posters, so the addition of a repost feature could help ensure that creators receive credit when their content is shared widely.

It makes sense for Instagram to introduce the ability to repost, especially since the format has been adopted by other social networks like Threads and TikTok. It's worth noting that reposts were popularized by Twitter's introduction of [the "Retweet" feature](#) back in 2009.

As with any other test feature, it's unknown when or if Instagram plans to release its repost functionality to all users.

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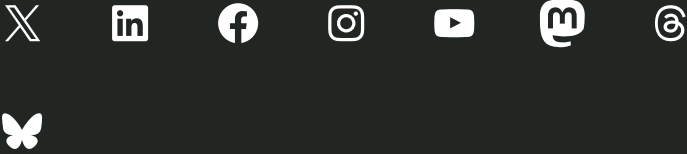


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